

U.S. Multi Industry & Electrical Equipment

US Industrials: 30 exhibits on the state of cooling and electrical equip. procurement in North American Data Centers



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We ran a survey of 50 data center procurement leaders (~40% hyperscalers, ~60% colos / neoclouds / enterprise DCs) making purchase decisions for North American projects to understand where ever-changing market dynamics currently sit. We did this at the equipment level (e.g., for PDUs, CDUs, Chillers, etc.) offering a level of granularity that we do not believe exists for investors today. Key insights highlighted below. The raw survey data can be accessed [here](#).

Ordering patterns: Double ordering (or more accurately, excess ordering) seems to be a phenomenon for ~50% or more of the respondent set. When it does take place, we see the magnitude of excess orders are north of 20% for a material share of the respondent set (and in some cases north of 50% excess equipment) with some nuance by product type. Excess capacity concerns seem overblown; in most cases lead times have tightened, not lowered. Cancellation penalties also seem to be more punitive than we initially anticipated (we were worried customers could cancel orders for <10% of their down payment; that does not seem to be the case). **Our takeaway here is that we expect to see near-term market strength for equipment players, and even if data center build slows, relatively punitive cancellation terms could incentivize customers to still take delivery of some equipment. However, it also implies that longer-term, equipment demand is being pulled forward and when capex does slow, customers will likely have surplus stock of cooling and power making the slowdown all the more painful.**

Modular and pre-fab: Modular and pre-fab are expected to increase significantly in prevalence over the coming months (~60% of respondents expect an increase while 40% expect it to remain relatively unchanged). ~50% would find value in having both IT/cooling pods and power pods, however, there still does not seem to be a strong impact on willingness to source both these types of pods from a single vendor even when offered.

Company Perceptions: While we expected some combination of Vertiv / Eaton / Schneider to top these results, Schneider in particular seems to be >20% of spend for ~60% of respondents (across both power and cooling). Vertiv was a major supplier for around ~40% of respondents while Eaton is around 20% for power and 30% for cooling.

Power Generation: While this survey was primarily focused on cooling and electrical equipment, we did ask a question about BTM, and ~60% of respondents believe new data center projects will be powered using BTM at least in part for primary gen.

800V DC: ~45% of respondents have an 800V DC project already under operation or expect it to be underway by 2027. The remainder expect their initial 800V DC capacity to come online by 2028 or later. This is largely in line with our expectations that the vast majority of ramp up happens in 2028 or later (since all responses here refer to the initial project). Schneider, Siemens, ABB, GE Vernova, and Eaton seem to lead the pack in perception (>50% of respondents would be willing to purchase an SST from these players), although we acknowledge that this is a rapidly changing space and new launches / progress will likely shift the balance here.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	Cur	19 Aug 2026	Price Target	TTM	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
			Closing		Rel.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
VRT (Vertiv)	O	USD	261.00	368.00	82.7%	USD	4.20	6.60	9.06	62.2	39.5	28.8
NVT (nVent)	O	USD	156.88	229.00	54.9%	USD	3.34	5.15	6.55	46.9	30.5	23.9
TT (Trane)	O	USD	455.48	575.00	(13.8)%	USD	13.06	15.28	17.79	34.9	29.8	25.6
JCI (Johnson Controls)	O	USD	144.94	190.00	15.6%	USD	3.78	5.09	6.35	38.4	28.5	22.8
CARR (Carrier)	M	USD	61.20	78.00	(29.8)%	USD	2.57	2.85	3.29	23.8	21.5	18.6
GEV (GE Vernova)	O	USD	987.46	1,298.00	36.5%	USD	17.70	28.30	29.49	55.8	34.9	33.5
ENPH (Enphase Energy)	M	USD	39.37	56.00	(13.1)%	USD	1.29	0.58	1.22	30.6	67.3	32.4
LR.FP (Legrand)	O	EUR	134.65	170.00	(13.5)%	EUR	5.22	6.13	6.86	25.8	22.0	19.6
SU.FP (Schneider)	O	EUR	294.30	350.00	19.7%	EUR	8.43	10.42	13.24	34.9	28.2	22.2
ABB.N.SW (ABB)	M	CHF	79.60	80.00	31.7%	USD	2.56	3.02	3.63	39.0	33.0	27.5
SIE.GR (Siemens)	O	EUR	276.75	330.00	1.0%	EUR	12.23	11.29	11.64	27.8	23.9	22.5
ENR.GR (Siemens Energy)	O	EUR	153.26	210.00	48.6%	EUR	1.63	4.24	5.94	36.8	20.4	14.6
ETN (Eaton)	O	USD	424.67	534.00	0.5%	USD	12.07	13.45	16.37	35.2	31.6	25.9
HUBB (Hubbell)	O	USD	475.64	584.00	(10.5)%	USD	18.33	20.50	24.03	25.9	23.2	19.8
DLR (Digital Realty)	O	USD	192.35	226.00	(2.5)%	USD	3.87	3.09	3.21	49.7	62.2	60.0
EQIX (Equinix)	O	USD	1,077.08	1,270.00	19.7%	USD	14.96	17.79	20.87	72.0	60.5	51.6
CSQR (Csquare)	O	USD	20.45	27.00	NA	USD	0.00	(1.34)	(1.06)		(15.2)	(19.2)
SPX			7,707.98									
EDME			1,616.62									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

GEV, ENPH, SIE.GR, ENR.GR estimate is Reported EPS; GEV, ENPH valuation is Reported P/E (x); ENR.GR valuation is EV/EBITDA (x);

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

We rate VRT Outperform, TP \$368

We rate NVT Outperform, TP \$229

We rate TT Outperform, TP \$575

We rate JCI Outperform, TP \$190

We rate CARR Market-Perform, TP \$78

We rate GEV Outperform, TP \$1298

We rate ENPH Market-Perform, TP \$56

We rate Schneider (PT €350), Siemens (PT €330), Legrand (PT €170), and Siemens Energy (PT €210) Outperform, and ABB (PT CHF 80) Market-Perform.

We rate ETN (TP \$534) and HUBB (TP \$584) Outperform

We rate DLR (TP \$226), EQIX (TP \$1270), and CSQR (TP \$27) Outperform

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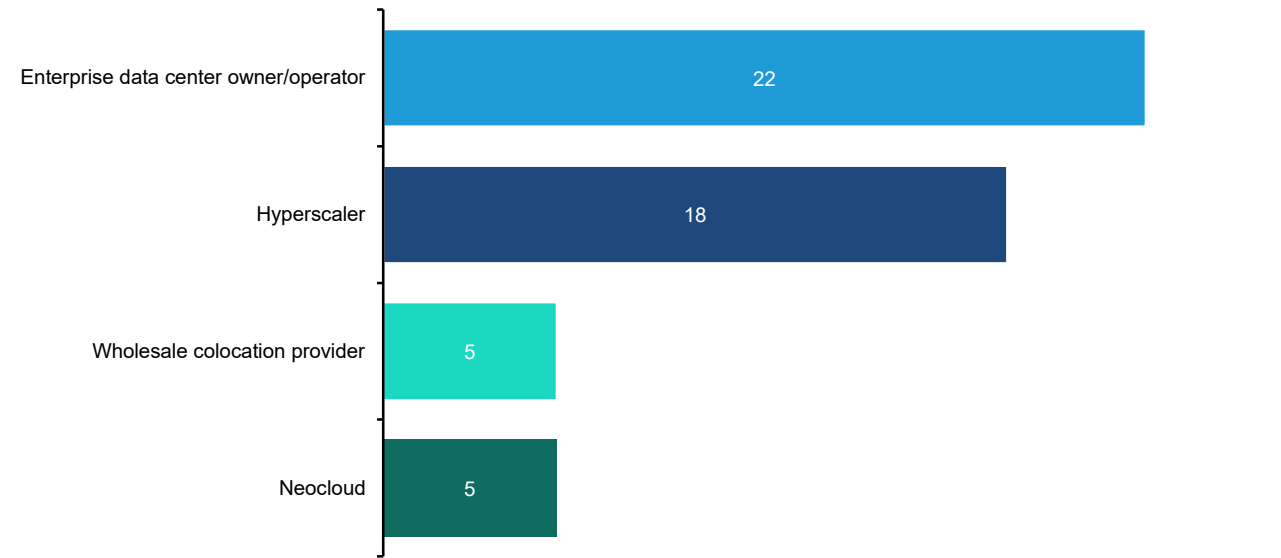
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DETAILS

RESPONDENT DEMOGRAPHICS

EXHIBIT 1: Which of the following best describes the type of organization for which you make or influence data center infrastructure decisions?

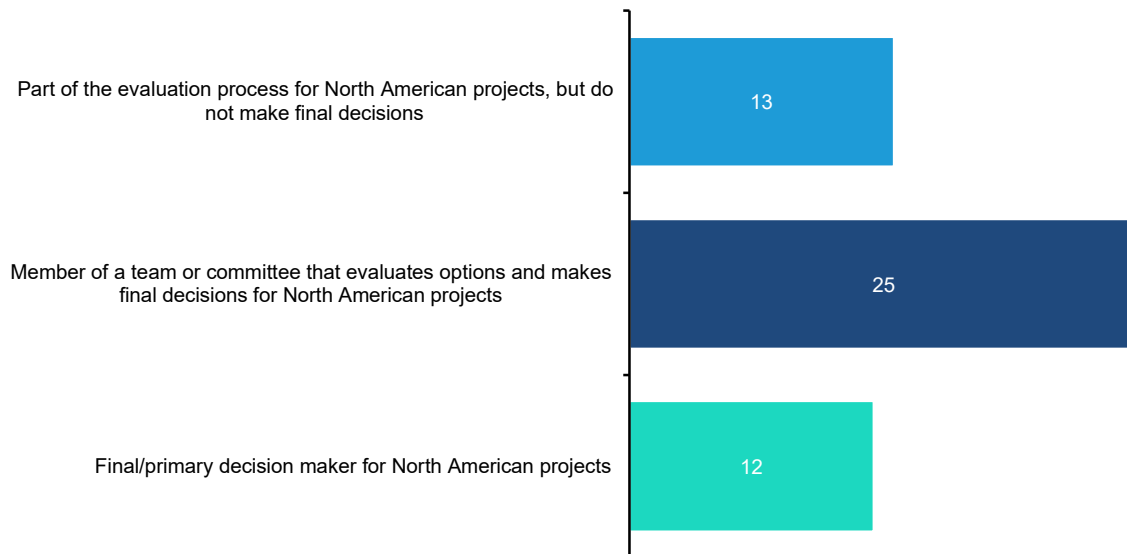
No. of respondents



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 2: How much influence do you have over purchasing power and cooling equipment for your organization's North American data center projects?

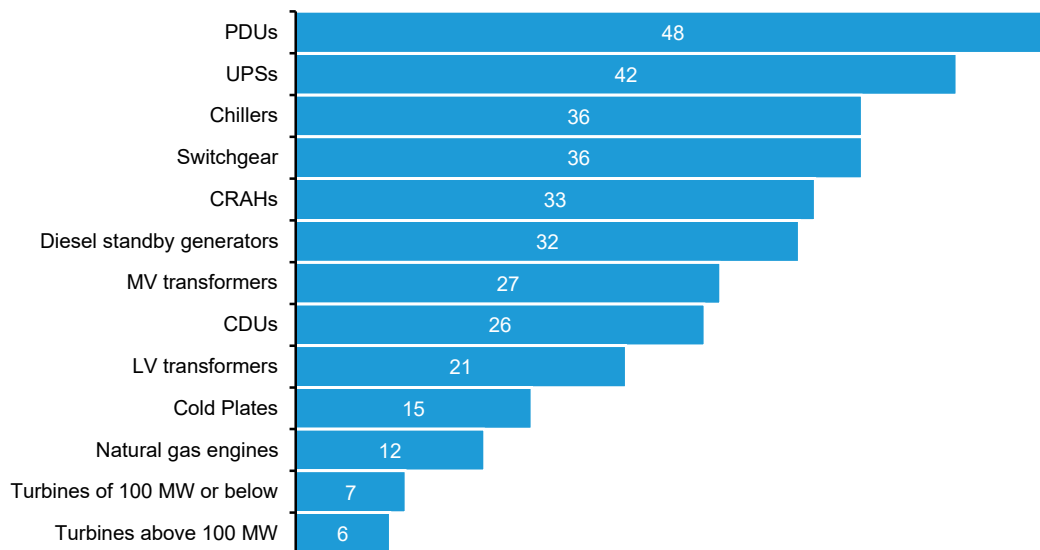
No. of respondents



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 3: For which equipment types could you answer questions about North American supply conditions, including ordering behavior, OEM lead times, cancellation terms, and buyer negotiating leverage?

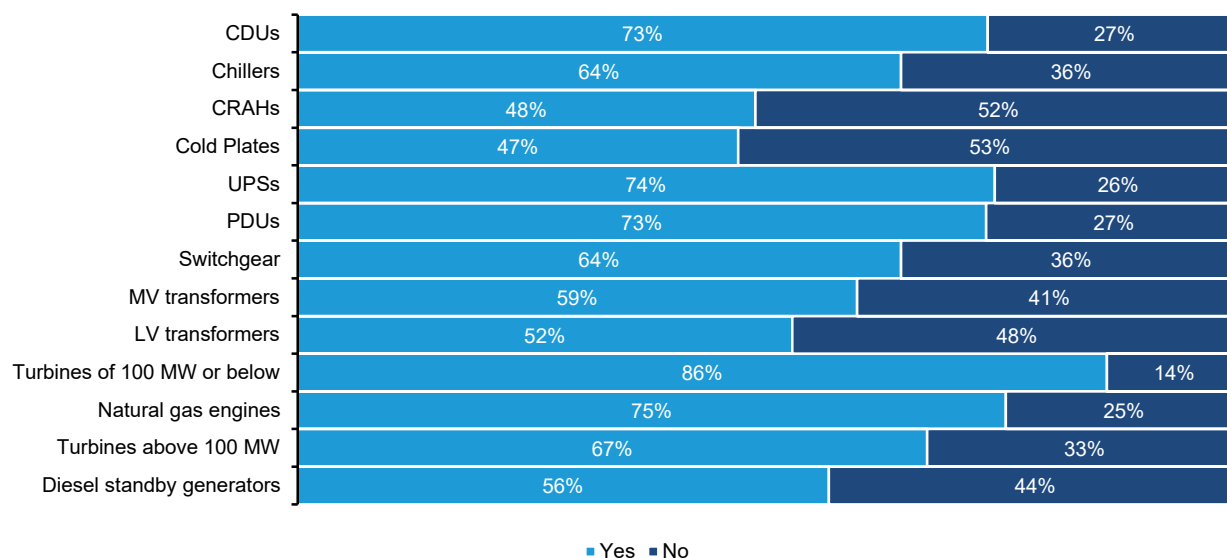
No. of respondents



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis. Note: these are the number of qualified responses for each piece of equipment.

DATA CENTER COOLING AND POWER EQUIPMENTS ORDERING BEHAVIOR AND SUPPLY CONDITIONS

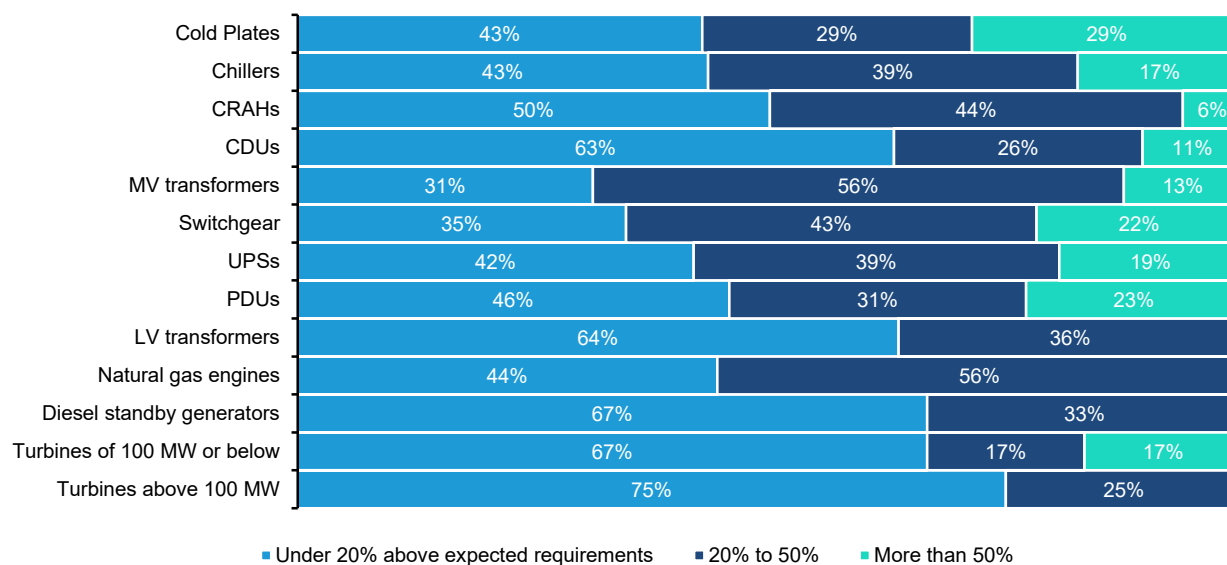
EXHIBIT 4: **For which equipment types does your organization currently place overlapping orders (double orders) with multiple OEMs in order to improve the likelihood of securing sufficient supply?**



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

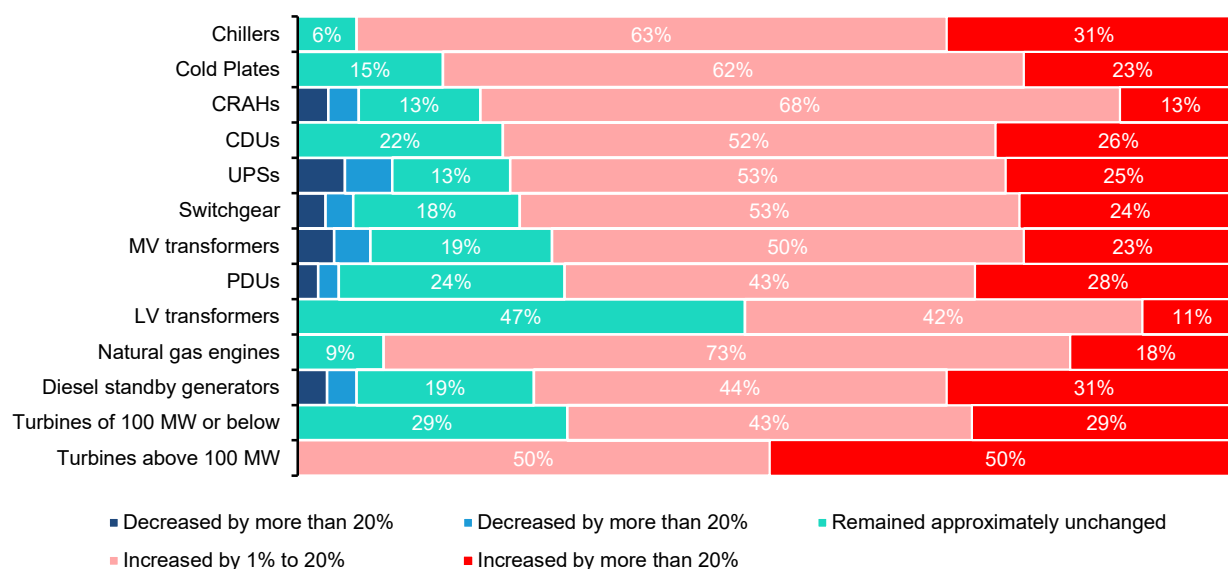
EXHIBIT 5: **For the equipment types where you place overlapping orders (i.e., double ordering), approximately how much is currently ordered above the quantity ultimately expected to be required?**

N=44



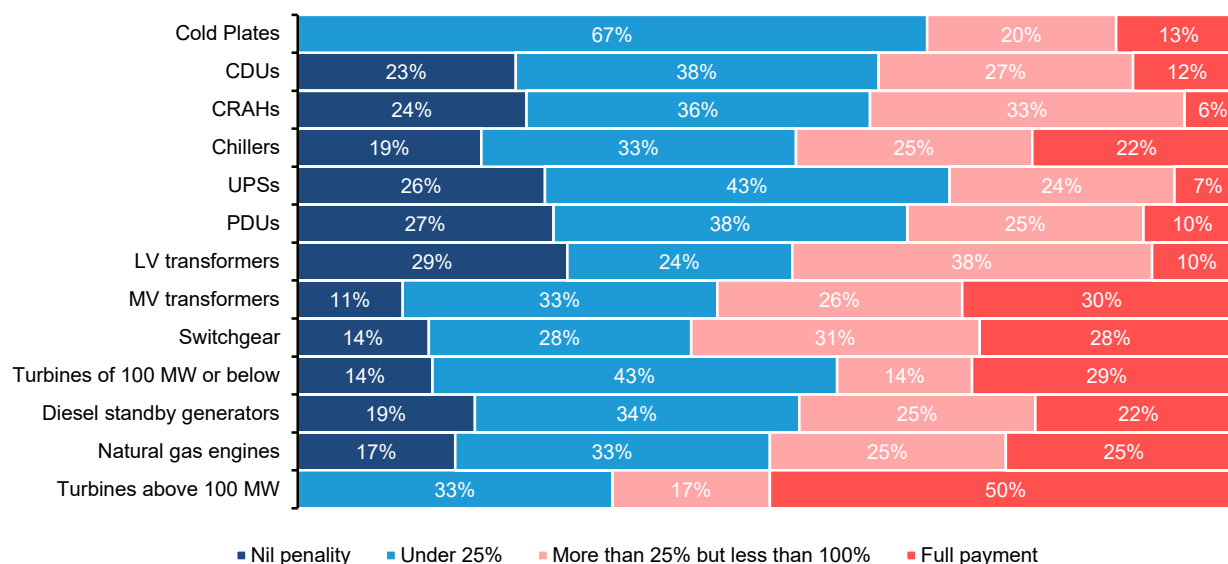
Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 6: Compared with approximately 12 months ago, how have typical OEM lead times changed for each equipment type?



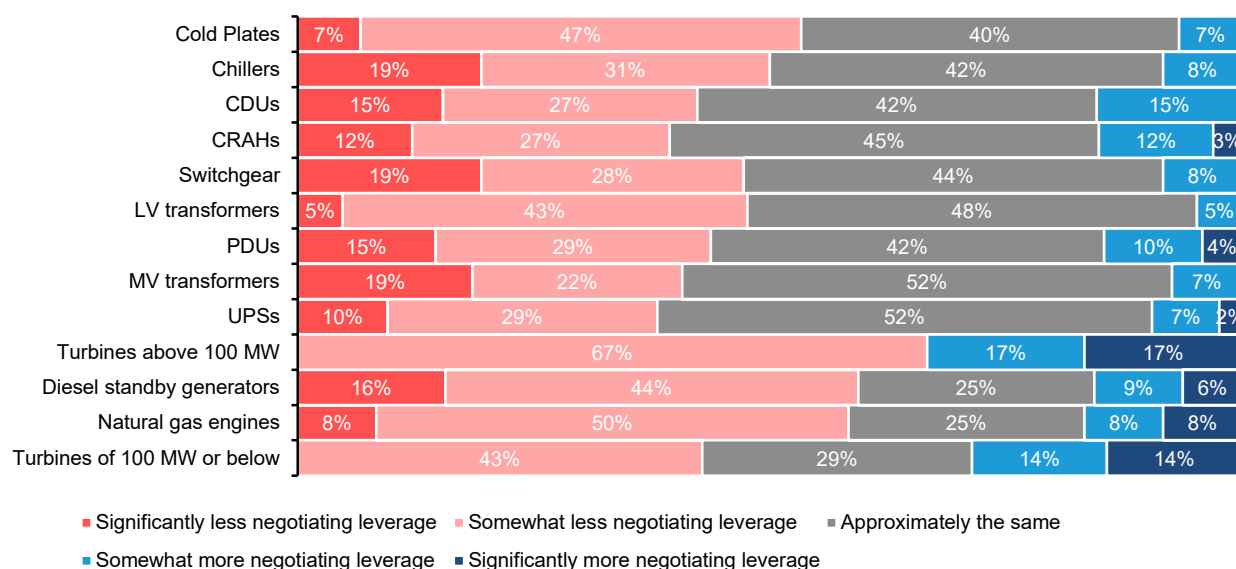
Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 7: Based on your general experience, what cancellation penalty typically applies to each equipment type?



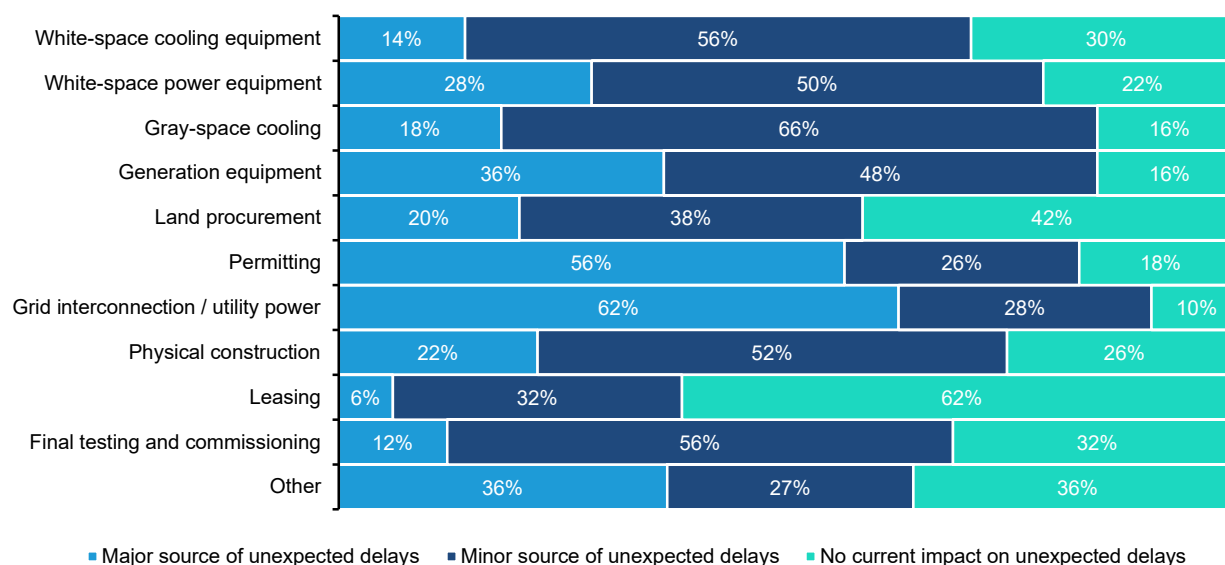
Source: Proprietary data centre equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 8: Compared with approximately 12 months ago, how has buyers' negotiating leverage (i.e., your employer's negotiating leverage) with OEMs changed for each equipment type?



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

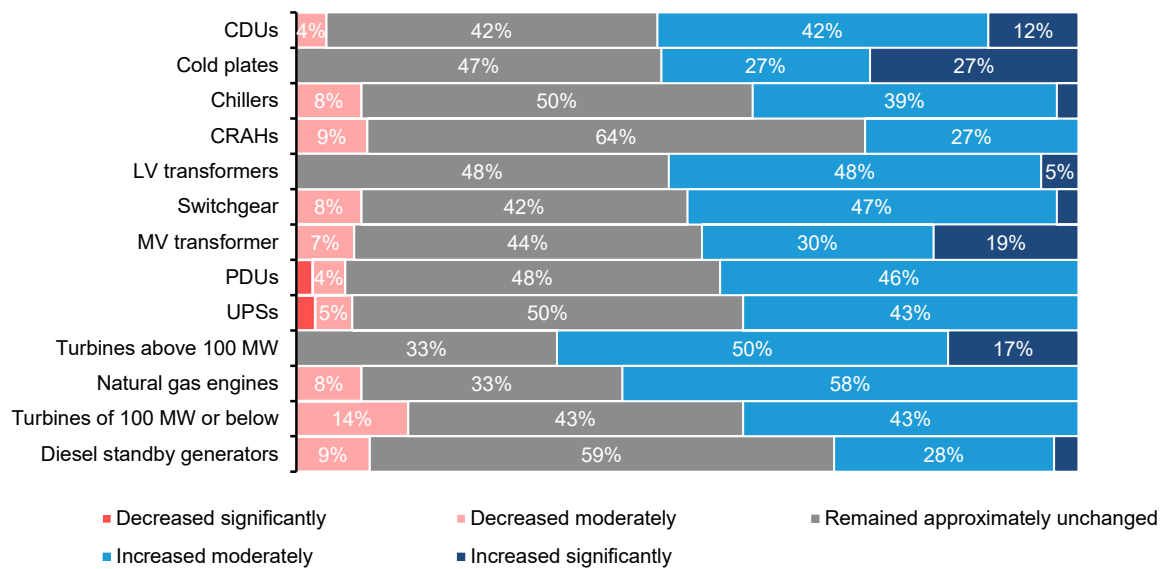
EXHIBIT 9: To what extent is each factor currently creating unexpected delays or negative schedule surprises, rather than delays already reflected in project plans?



Other delays - Major source (Legacy equipment procurement; Moratoriums at the state and local levels; High voltage transformers and Standby Diesel Generators; Public opinions and politics), Minor source (Such as components shortages and supply chain complexities; Customs and Tariffs; Funding and budget), No current impact (Racks, GPU Servers and other compute gear)

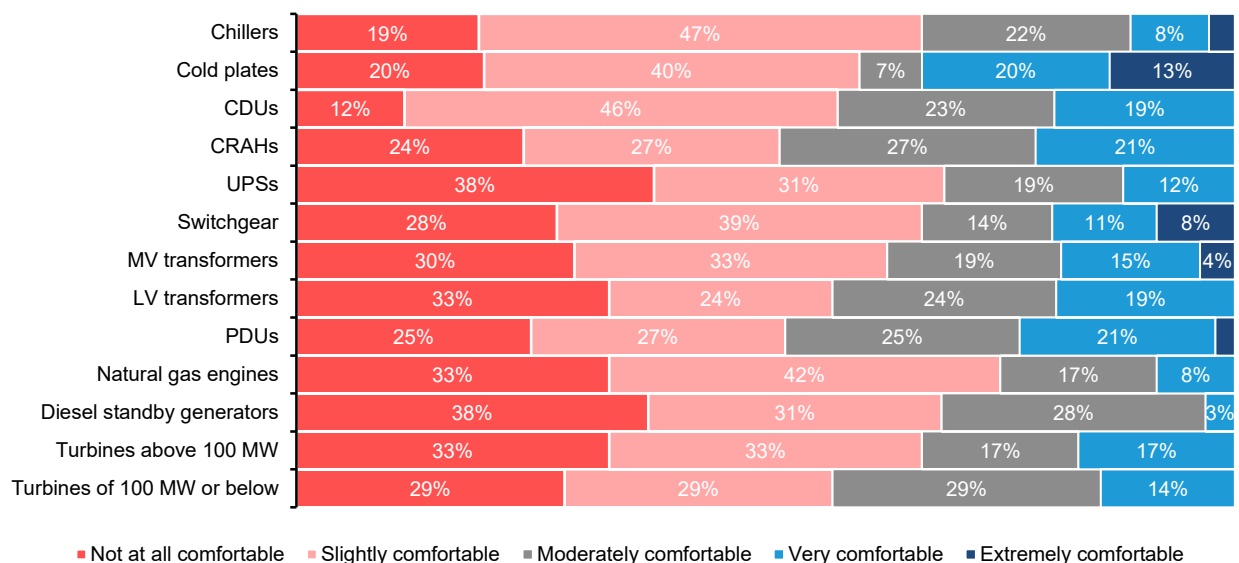
Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 10: Compared with approximately 12 months ago, how has the visibility of Asian-headquartered OEMs in the North American market changed for each equipment type?



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

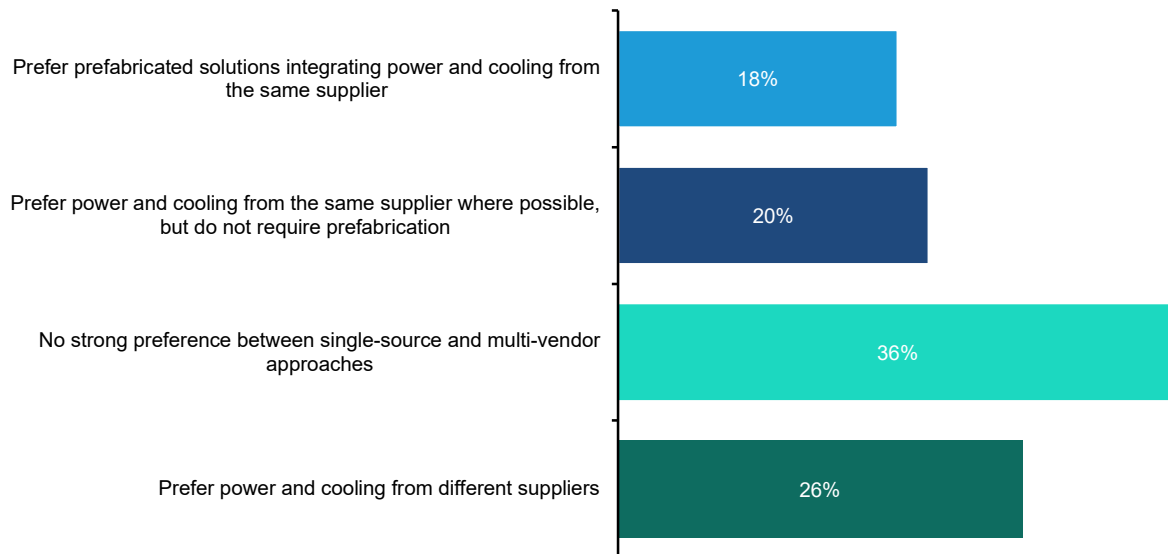
EXHIBIT 11: How comfortable would your organization be ordering each equipment type from a vendor that is not currently on its preferred or approved vendor list?



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

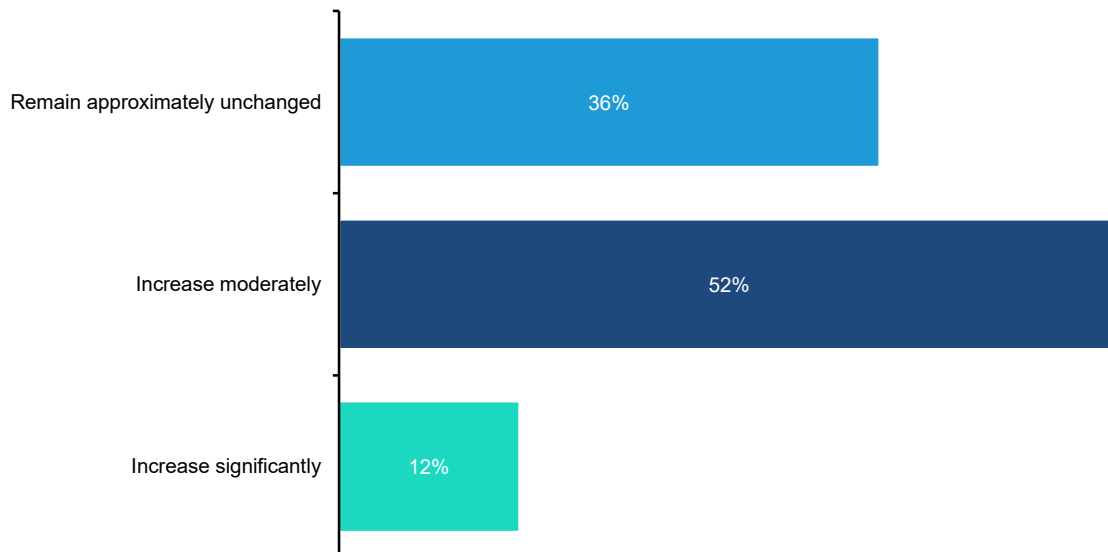
PERSPECTIVES ON MODULAR AND PRE-FAB

EXHIBIT 12: **Which statement best describes your organization's preferred approach to sourcing power and cooling infrastructure for an individual data center site?**



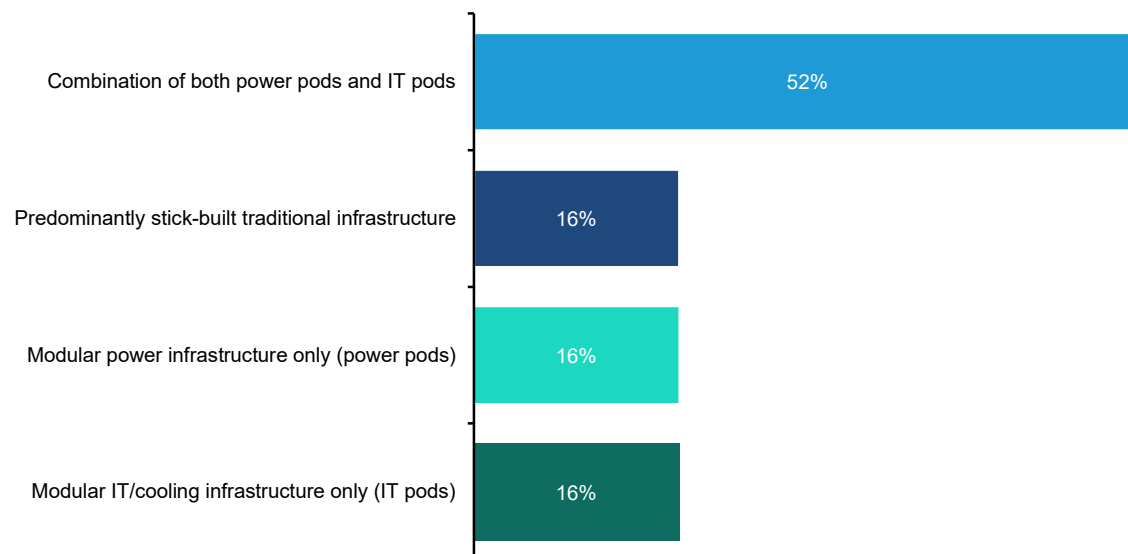
Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 13: **Compared with projects currently under construction, how do you expect the share of prefabricated or modular infrastructure to change in your organization's next generation of data centers?**



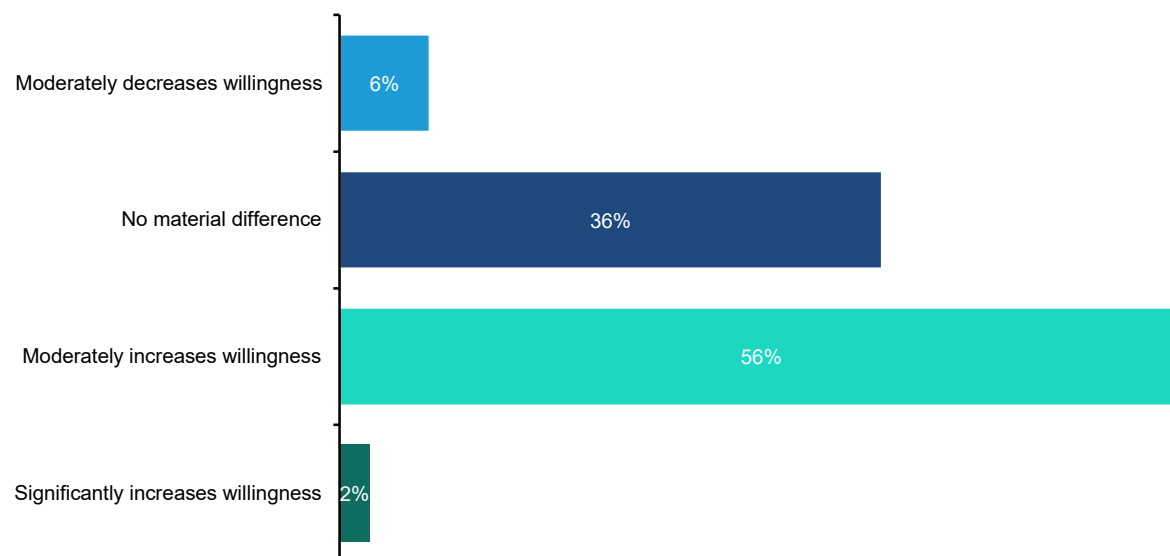
Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 14: **Which approach would your organization prefer for future AI data center deployments?**



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 15: **Compared with traditional site-built infrastructure, how does prefabricated or modular infrastructure affect your organization's willingness to source power and cooling equipment from a single OEM?**

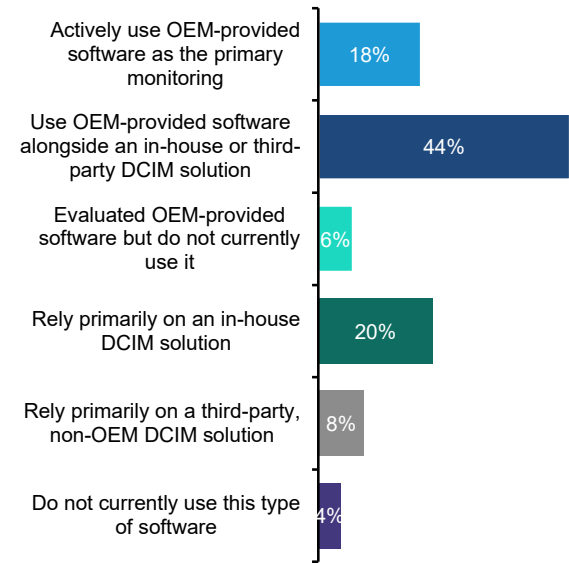


Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

DATA CENTER SOFTWARE

EXHIBIT 16: Which statement best describes your organization's use of software to manage power or cooling equipment in the data center?

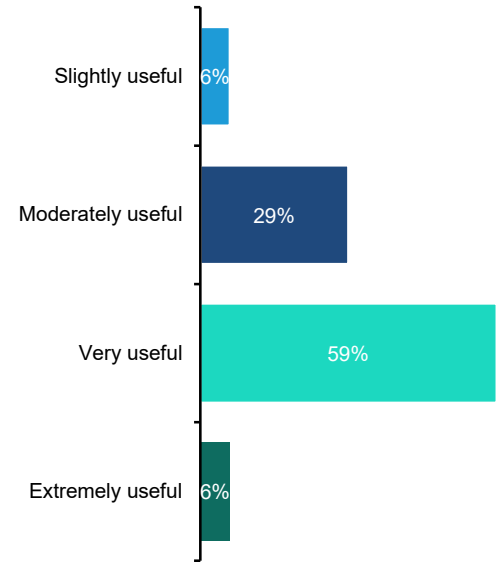
N=50



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 17: How useful is OEM-provided software for monitoring or optimizing data center equipment?

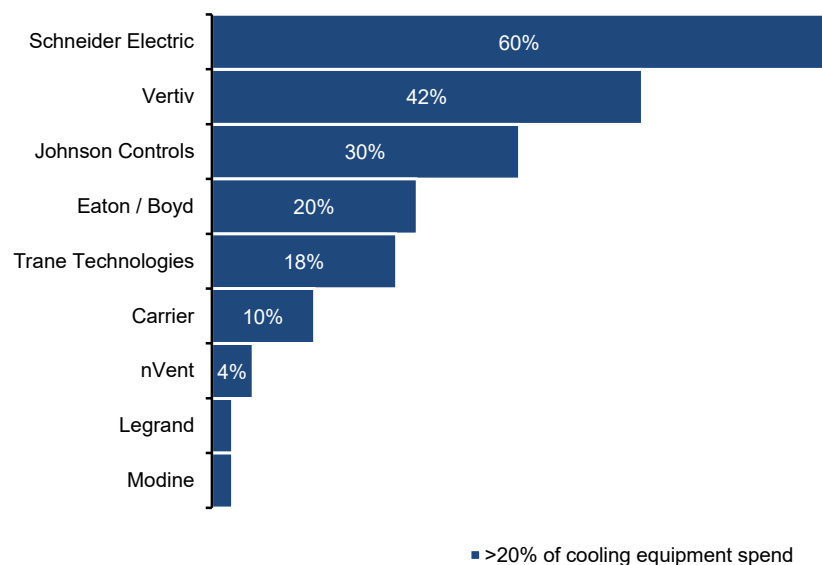
N=34



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

DATA CENTER PLAYERS SHARE OF WALLET

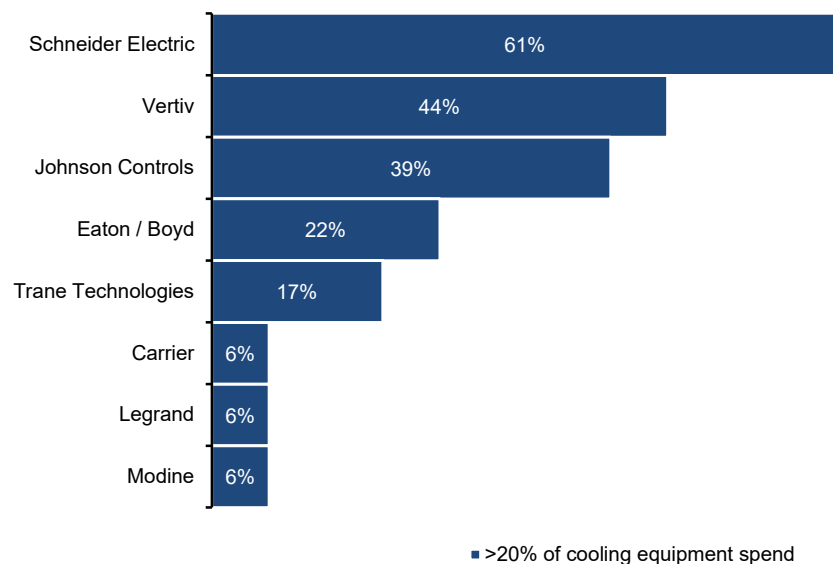
EXHIBIT 18: **What is your organization's relationship with each cooling equipment vendor?**



Due to an administrative error, CoolIT was not listed as an option. This survey should not be used to infer their market share.
Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 19: **What is your organization's relationship with each cooling equipment vendor?**

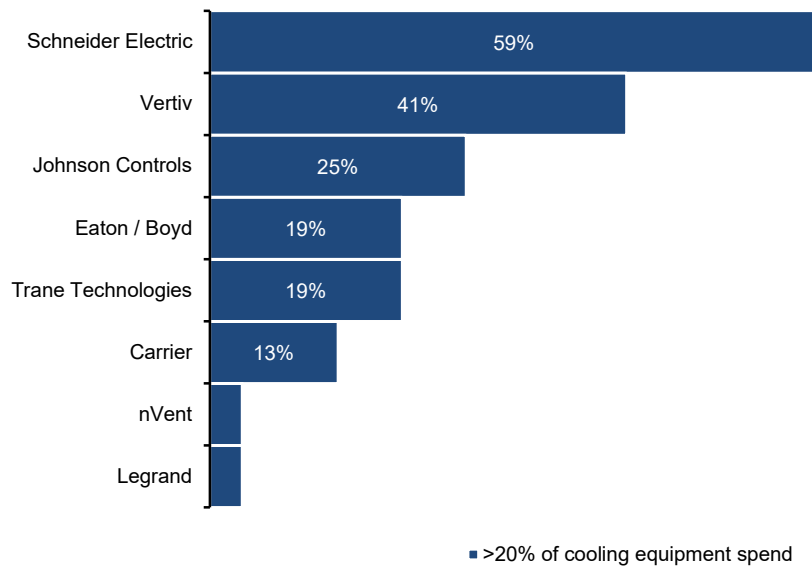
N = 18 (Hyperscaler)



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

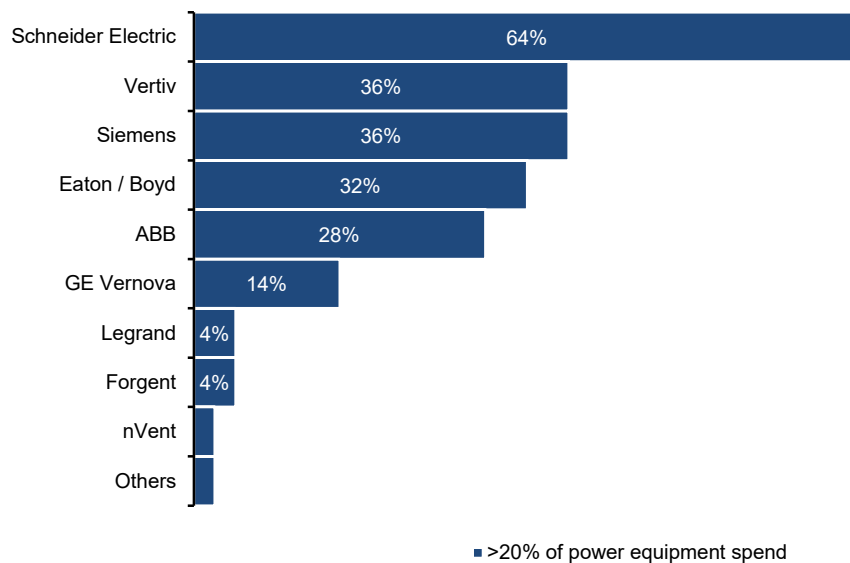
EXHIBIT 20: **What is your organization's relationship with each cooling equipment vendor?**

N = 32 (Non hyperscaler)



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

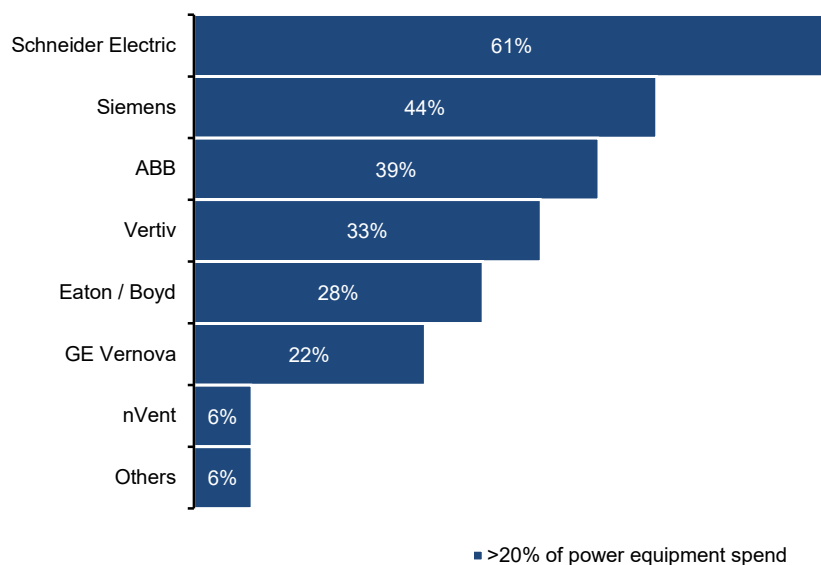
EXHIBIT 21: **What is your organization's relationship with each power equipment vendor?**



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 22: **What is your organization's relationship with each power equipment vendor?**

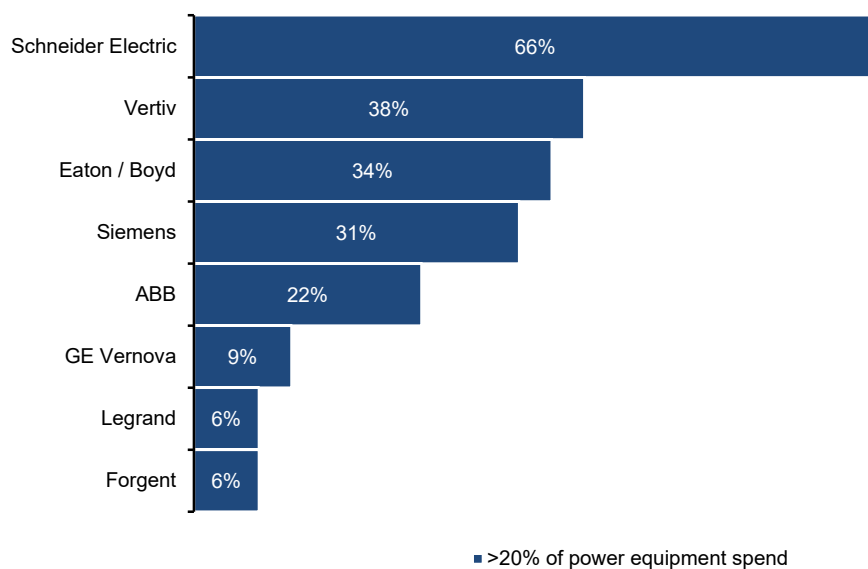
N = 18 (Hyperscaler)



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 23: **What is your organization's relationship with each power equipment vendor?**

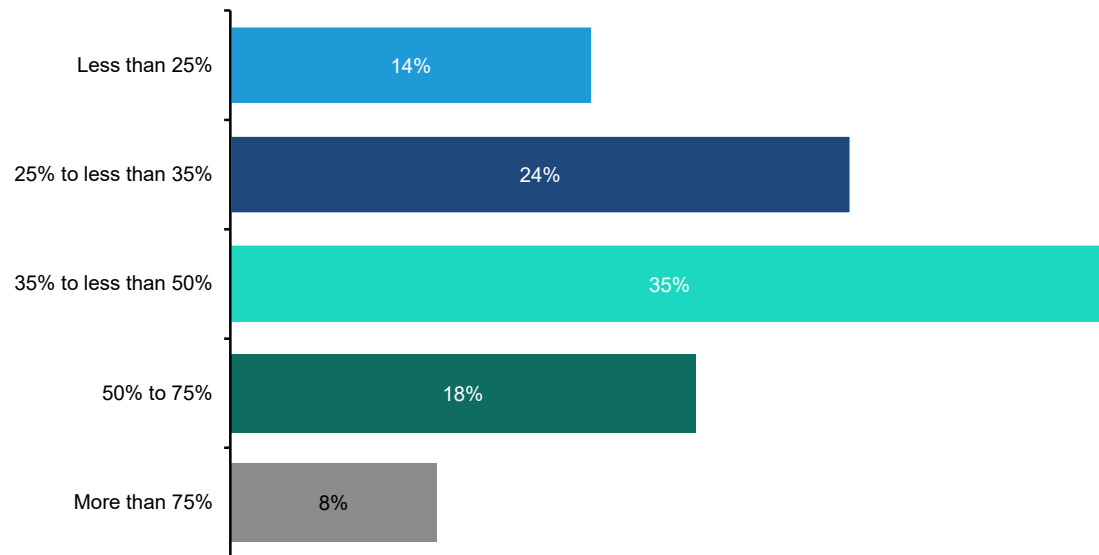
N = 32 (Non hyperscaler)



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

BEHIND THE METER POWER GENERATION

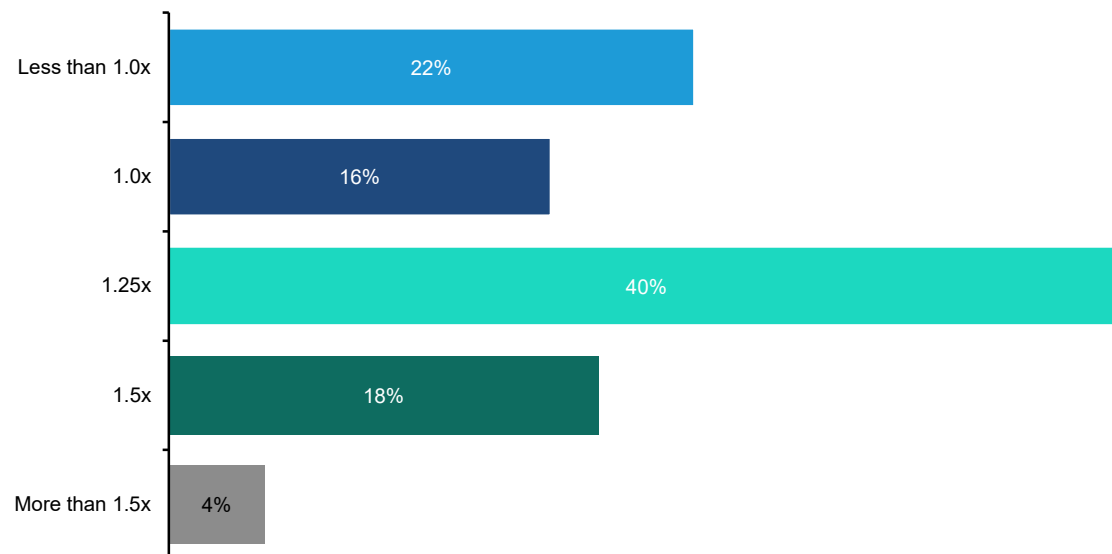
EXHIBIT 24: Based on your view of the North American market, what percentage of data centers beginning construction in the next 12 months will use behind-the-meter generation for at least part of their primary power requirements?



'Do not know': 1 respondent

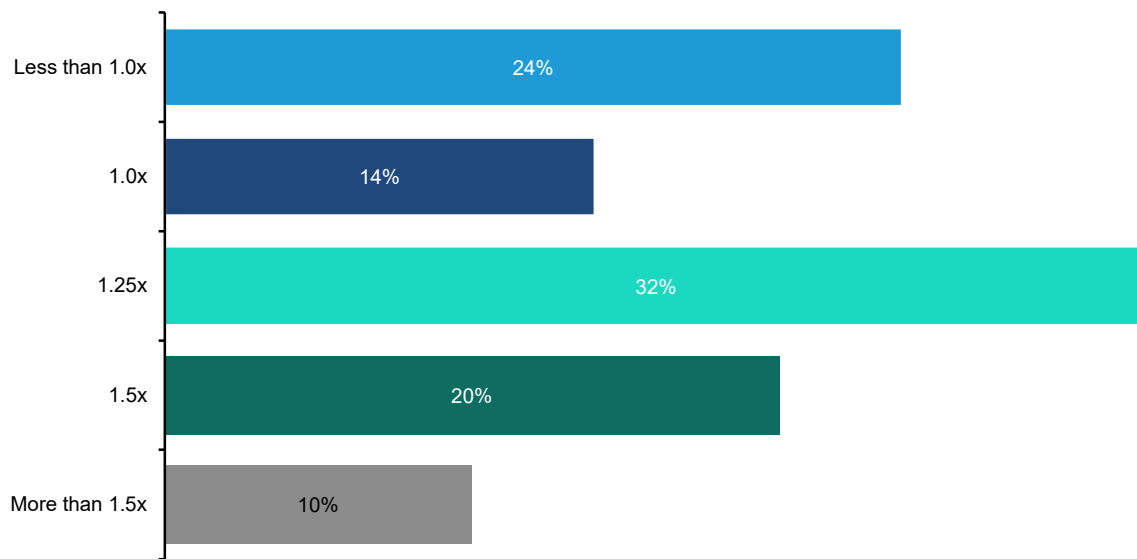
Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 25: What is the typical ratio of installed behind-the-meter generation capacity to planned IT load for your organization's applicable projects?



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

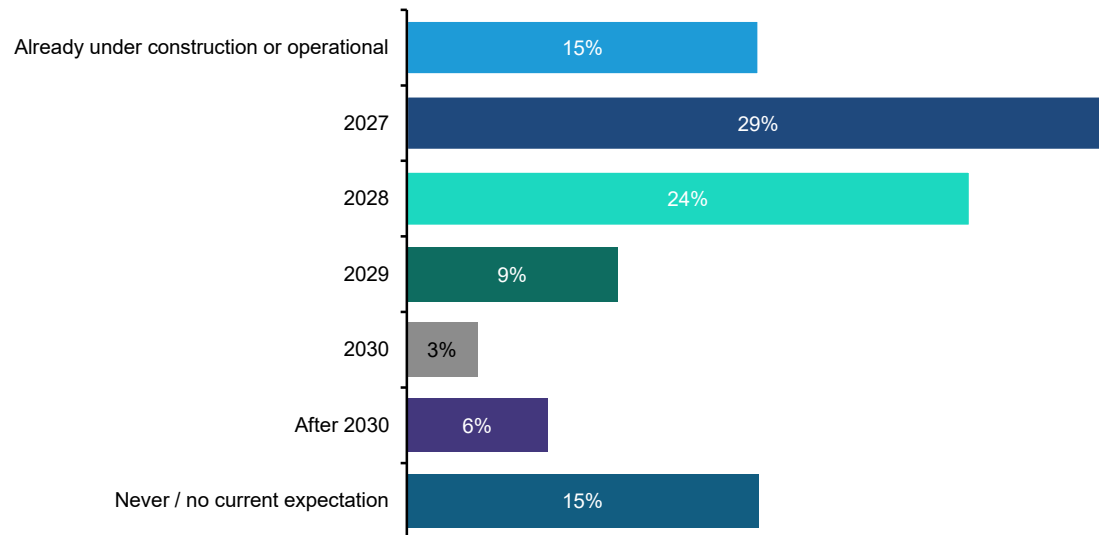
EXHIBIT 26: What is the typical ratio of installed diesel standby generation capacity to planned IT load for your organization's projects?



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

800V DC POWER ARCHITECTURE

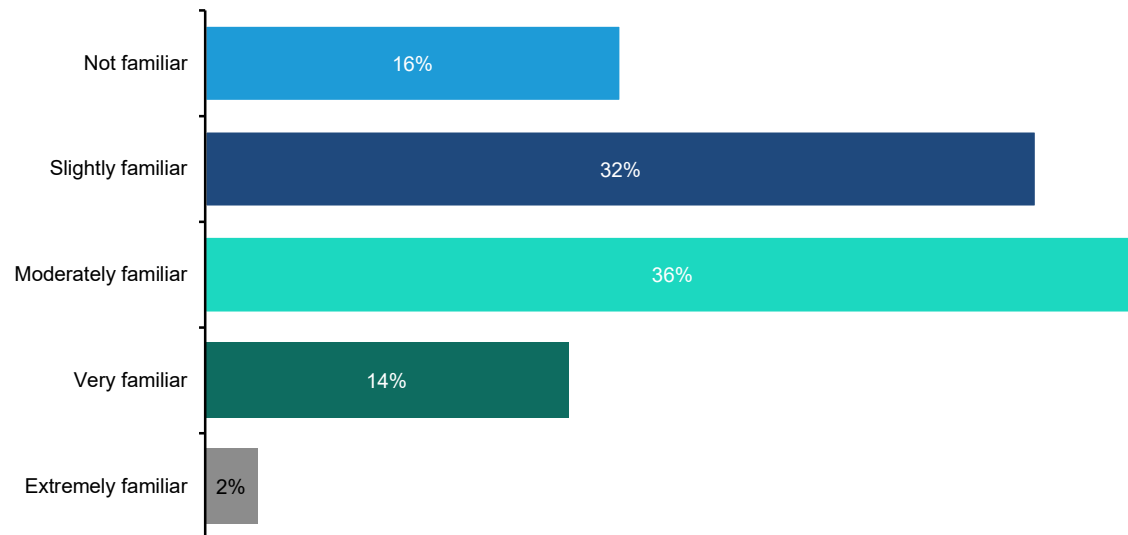
EXHIBIT 27: When do you expect your organization to begin construction of its first data center using an 800V DC power architecture?



'Do not know / cannot discuss': 16 respondents

Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

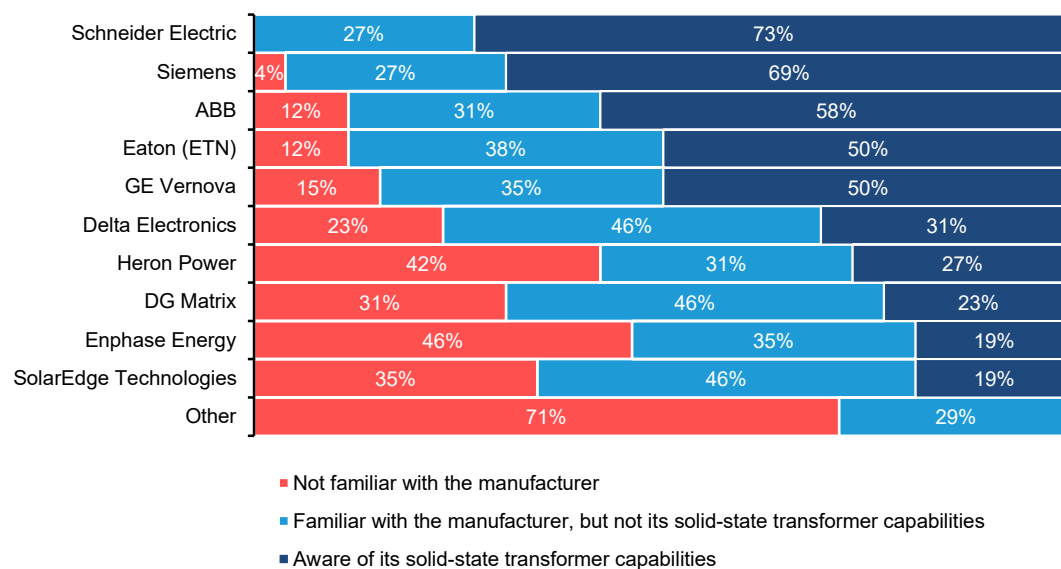
EXHIBIT 28: How familiar are you with solid-state transformer technology for data center applications?



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 29: **How familiar are you with each manufacturer's solid-state transformer offering or capabilities?**

N=26

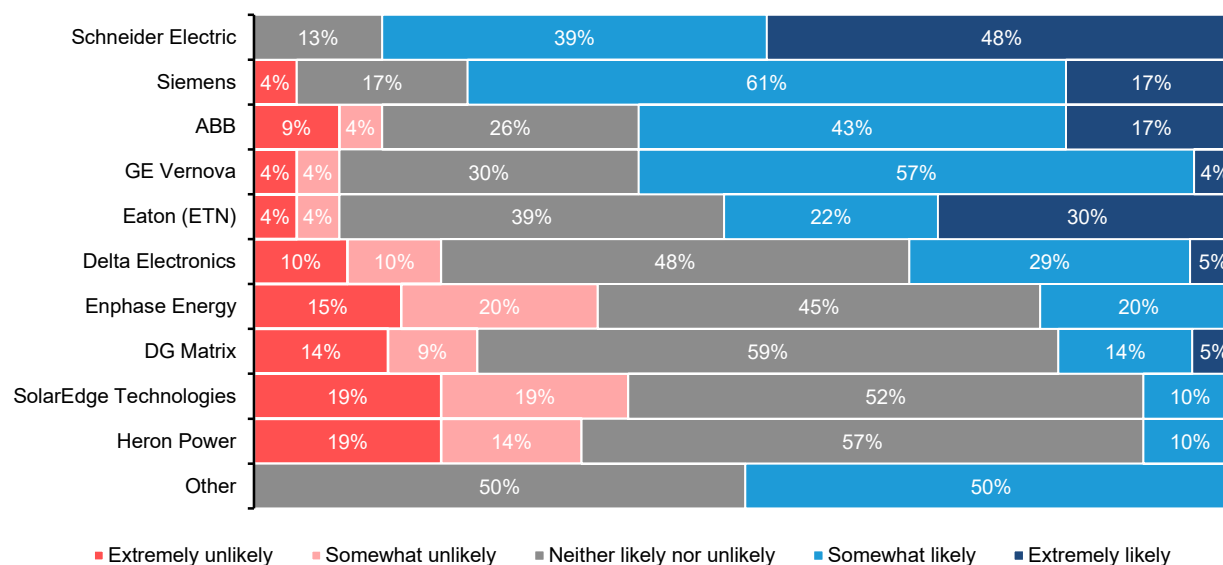


Other - Familiar with the manufacturer, but not its solid-state transformer capabilities: Hitachi Energy; ITT

Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 30: **Based on what you know today, how likely would your organization be to consider purchasing a solid-state transformer from each manufacturer?**

N=23



Source: Proprietary data center equipment survey, Bernstein analysis

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Autonomous preferred stock ratings are based on a 6-month time horizon.

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